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Language stay

London & Kuala Lumpur



From 20th December to 22nd February

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Annexe: RESERVATION

London

1. Arrival and First Impressions

I left very early on Friday, December 20, to catch the ferry at 8:25. It was a pleasant crossing. It was also the first time I had taken a ferry to go to London. I already knew the word “ferry,” but I might have confused it with “cruise ship.” After checking, I understood the difference: a ferry is smaller and transports people and vehicles, while a cruise ship is mainly for passengers.

When I arrived, I first went to Canterbury. I wanted to visit the cathedral, but parking the car was extremely difficult. I think one of the biggest difficulties I faced in England was finding a place to park. I asked an old man for help. He was very kind, but his accent surprised me: it was a strong British accent, and I am more used to the American accent. This made me realize how challenging British pronunciation can be.

After that, I spoke to another person, and she had the same kind of accent. It sometimes sounded like they were speaking with something in their mouth, which was surprising but also interesting, and I love it. I also noticed that people spoke quite slowly, which helped me understand better.

Since I couldn’t park, I decided to leave and planned to come back later during the stay. I then headed to my host family in Bexleyheath, London.

When I arrived, the host was waiting for me at the door. She was very kind and showed me my room, explaining everything I needed to know. Everything was clear, except for one word: “heater.” I understood what she meant from the context, but I didn’t know the word before. So I learned “wall heater” and “room heater,” since I had both in my room.

Unfortunately, even though the host was kind and available if I had questions, I didn’t have many opportunities to speak with her or the other students staying in the house. I never actually met them. I could sometimes hear them, but everyone stayed in their own room.

However, that was okay because I spoke with many people outside, mainly to ask for information.

2. Daily Challenges and Adaptation

That was not a problem for me, because I spoke with many people outside, mostly to ask for information.

When I went to Oxford Road, I faced the same problem again: where could I park? I saw a sign indicating that I had to pay using my phone, but I didn’t know how.

I noticed a man who seemed to work there. I wasn't sure if he was a policeman or a security agent, but I asked him how to pay. He told me to download an application called RingGO. I tried to create an account, but I never received the confirmation code.

He kindly gave me his phone so I could call the service. I spoke with an automated system, but it didn't understand that my car registration was French, so it didn't work either. I eventually gave up after thanking him.

Later, I went to South Hampstead to find a restaurant because I was starving. But again, the same issue: parking. I would have preferred a machine like in France. It is less technological but much easier.

I met another man in uniform and asked him if I had to pay with my phone. Unfortunately, the answer was yes. I explained my problem, and he offered to help me. He asked me to move the car and park further away, then explained the way to follow while walking.

I even offered him to get into the car, but he refused because he was on duty. While giving directions, I noticed that he didn't use expressions like "go ahead," which I was used to. I forgot the word that he used but I could understand it. I realized I needed to learn more everyday expressions.

3. Language Learning in Everyday Life

The next day, I saw a car with "Royal Mail" written on it. At first, I thought it was related to the king, but after doing some research, I understood that it is simply the British postal service.

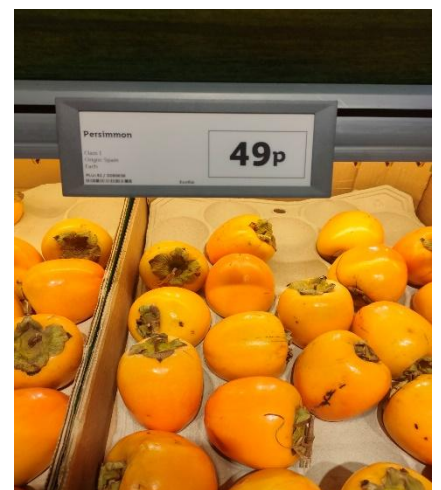


"persimmon." It was not expensive, but I was surprised by the name and forgot to buy it.

While waiting for the bus, I saw the expression "this bus pulls in frequently." I learned that "pulls in" means "arrives" or "stops." I also learned that "passing" can be used to describe overtaking another vehicle.

Because parking was too complicated, I decided to stop using the car and take the bus instead. I quickly realized that many places were actually close enough to walk.

I went to a Lidl supermarket in Bexleyheath. It was very large, with two floors. Inside, I saw a fruit that I like but didn't know the name of in English:



During these days, I stayed in the neighborhood and explored it. There was a pedestrian street with many shops, although I preferred the ones in Lille.

I learned new words such as “humps,” which refers to speed bumps. I also had to adapt to the use of miles and yards instead of kilometres and meters.

In a fast-food restaurant, I ordered a “menu,” but the employee didn’t understand. He repeated “menu?” and then said “deal.” I understood that the correct term is “meal deal.” At that moment, it was clear that I was not from the country. A child sitting nearby even wished me a Merry Christmas.

Later, while shopping, a sales assistant said “cheers” to me. I didn’t understand at first, but I later learned that it could mean “thank you” or “goodbye.”

And when I was waiting for my bus, I saw a sign on a bus saying, “this bus pulls in frequently”. “Pulls”? I learned that “pulls in” means “passes” or “arrives”. On another bus, I also understood that when a bus goes past another one, the action is called “passing”. I was wondering which word is used to say “double une voiture”, but in the end, the word was simply “passing”.



During these two days, I stayed in the neighbourhood and explored it. There was a pedestrian street with many markets, but I prefer the ones in Lille, with more stalls and more interesting things.

However, I was able to learn many new words while walking. When I was driving, I didn’t pay attention, but I didn’t know that the word “humps” is used for speed bumps.

Of course, in England, they don’t use meters or kilometres, but yards and miles. One yard is 0.9144 meters, and one mile is 1.60934

kilometres.



In a fast-food restaurant, I ordered a “menu,” but the employee didn’t understand. He repeated “menu?” and then said “oohh a deal.” I understood that they don’t use word “menu” but “deal”. At that moment, it was clear that I was not from the country.

Later, I went to do some shopping, and the sales assistant, when a paid, told me “Cheers”, I couldn’t understand what that meant, so I checked on interned and I learned that they use this world not only when they drink, but also to say thank you or bye.

I went to a shopping centre where, by chance, I found a book I had been looking for in France for weeks. I had already checked several stores, including Le Furet, but I couldn’t

find it. In Welling, I finally found it: *The Silent Patient*, a psychological thriller. I also bought another book, *Message Deleted* by K.L. Slater. I was very excited because there were many books I wanted to read, but I limited myself to two because of the price.

4. Transportation and Daily Adaptation

I stopped using the car because it was too difficult to drive and park in London. I started using the bus instead, which was much easier since I could simply pay with my credit card.

In another fast-food restaurant, I asked for a “deal,” and this time the employee understood me immediately. I was happy because I didn’t make the same mistake again.

On Christmas Day, I noticed a big cultural difference. Unlike in France, where people usually stay at home with family, the city was very lively. Even though shops were closed, many people were outside, especially in pubs. Families were dressed very elegantly: women wore beautiful dresses, men wore suits, and children were also well dressed, sometimes even in Disney costumes. The atmosphere was festive and very different from what I was used to. All pubs were full. That gave a good atmosphere.

One day, instead of taking the usual route by car, I decided to walk using Google Maps. The journey took much longer than expected (I spent 31 minutes walking instead of 15). It felt endless, but I learned a new word: “footpath,” which refers to a path for pedestrians only.



5. Social Interactions and Integration

I attended 4 public speeches. The first one was about Christmas traditions, but I couldn’t fully concentrate because someone next to me was making noise.

A few days later, I attended another speech about the situation in Gaza. The speaker talked about building a hospital and asked for donations. I found it very interesting, especially because of the emotional tone of the speaker.

During this event, I met a woman sitting next to me. At first, we had a small conversation about simple things, but it quickly turned into a longer discussion. She asked me about my origin, my studies, why I was there, and much more subject about our different opinion. This was the first real conversation I had during my stay, after several days of only short interactions.

I really enjoyed that moment because I had felt quite isolated and disappointed before because people are quite cold. Even when I tried to speak with my host, the conversations were very short.

The woman explained that in this place, people know each other well. The next day, I realized it was true because I saw the same people again at another speech, this time about happiness. I really liked the way the speaker talked, with a philosophical approach.

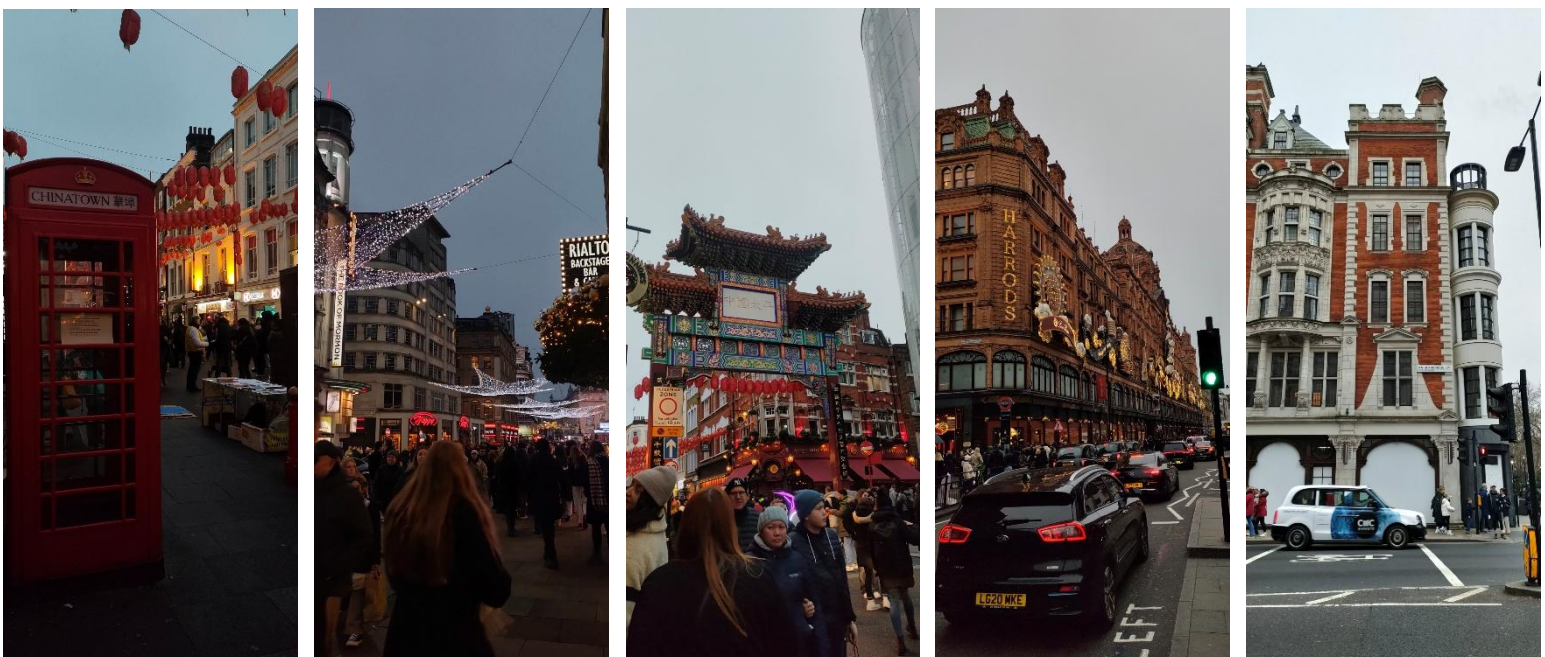
I also noticed something important: the English spoken in real life is much simpler than the English we study at university. People use simple words and structures that are easy to understand. The main difficulty remains the British accent.

On December 27, I attended another speech about happiness. Many people noticed that I was new and came to talk to me. I also recognized several faces from previous days. It felt good to start recognizing people and feeling more integrated. That was fun and great to speak with them. I did enjoy that moment.

6. Exploration of London

On December 28, I went to central London. It was my first time taking a train ticket directly at the station. The man who sold me the ticket had a very strong British accent, like a VERY strong accent, and I couldn't understand him at all, not even a word! Fortunately, another employee helped me, and his accent was much easier to understand.

This made me think that age might influence the accent, as the older man was harder to understand than the younger one.



In London, I visited several places such as Harrods, Chinatown, and Piccadilly Circus

In London, I visited several places such as Harrods, Chinatown, and Piccadilly Circus. It was a great experience, I could see and met a lot of native people. However, I noticed that I heard a lot of French. For fun, I pretended not to speak French when they were asking me something and spoke English with French people. It was amusing because they struggled to find their words, but at least it made them practice.



7. Historical Observations

While walking near Buckingham Palace, I noticed a memorial with inscriptions such as “Our future is greater than our past” and references to regions like Nepal, Africa, and the Caribbean.

Another inscription mentioned the five million volunteers from the Indian subcontinent, Africa, and the Caribbean who fought for Britain during the World Wars. I found it interesting because it reflects a part of British history that is not always

highlighted.



I also noticed that many people did not pay attention to these monuments. Before my studies, I wouldn't have noticed them either, but thanks to my courses in British civilization, I was able to understand their meaning and their importance.



And on another one, we could read that: *“in memory of the five million volunteers*

from the Indian sub-continent Africa and the Caribbean who fought with Britain in the two world wars.” With on another side again some

country: *India, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh.* That was interesting to see that memorial gate next to the Buckingham palace.

Because the British history is far from being a “cool”, and “peaceful” past. They have done many things that they cannot be denied, they must accept them. British history is deeply connected with many countries, including former close allies like France.

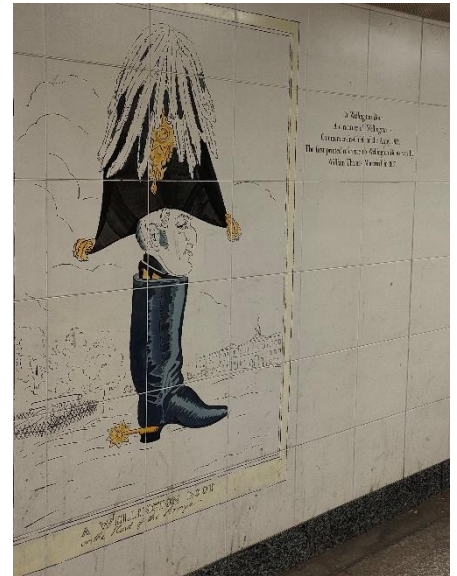


A few meters later, in Hyde Park, I saw a subway with caricatures:

‘A Wellington Boot’

A caricature of Wellington as Commander-in-chief of the Army, 1827.

The first printed reference to Wellington Boots was by William Thomas Moncrieff in 1817



The Life of Wellington (1769-1852)

Wellesley, the future Duke of Wellington, was born of an aristocratic Irish family in 1769, the same year as Napoleon Bonaparte

1846

The Duke riding from his office at the Horse Guards for the last time as Commander in chief.



8. Travel Difficulties and Problem-Solving

Later, I had to take the train to go back to Bexleyheath. I had checked how to go to London centre, but I forgot to check how to come back. I asked a worker who told me to take a train towards Dartford at 16:55, platform 3. However, another train to Dartford arrived earlier, at 16:10. Since I was already on the platform, I couldn't go back to ask again, so I asked someone else. He quickly said: "Yeah yeah, go, take this one." I got on the train, which left at 16:23. I didn't understand how it could leave earlier if it was supposed to be

at 16:55. After 30 minutes, I realized the train was not going in the right direction. I asked a couple sitting in front of me, and they confirmed it: I had taken the wrong train.

I was scared for a few minutes, especially because it was getting late, however, I managed to calm down, and the couple helped me a lot. They even recommended an application called Citymapper. I asked them how I could go back to Bexleyheath, which train I should take and where I should stop. They advised me to get off at the terminus in Dartford and then take a train towards London Victoria, which would stop at Bexleyheath after two stations. That is exactly what I did, and I managed to get home quite easily in the end.

Despite this mistake, the journey was positive: I spoke with several people, including two girls of my age, and many others to confirm directions. Their British accent was understandable; unlike one man I had met earlier whose accent was extremely difficult to understand.

However, I realised that I was not learning many new expressions, even though I had already spent a week in London and still had one week left. When I called my parents to tell them about my problem, explaining that I was there mainly to improve my English but did not feel like I was speaking enough, my mother suggested that I create a survey related to my studies. It was a very good idea because it would push me to talk to as many people as possible and learn more about their lives.

9. Survey Project and Communication Challenges

This is my survey:

- 1) Are you originally from England? If not, where are you from, and why did you choose to live in England?
- 2) Why did you choose to live in London?
- 3) Do you enjoy living here? If not, what is the main problem? If yes, why?
- 4) What expressions do you consider typical of London or England?
- 5) What English expression unique to England do you use in daily life?
- 6) What's your favourite expression?
- 7) What are the things you are the proudest of about England?
- 8) What is your opinion on the current state of the English economy?
- 9) In your opinion, do tourists influence the cost of living?
- 10) If you could change one thing about England today, what would it be and why?
- 11) If it were possible for you to leave England for free, would you do it? Why?

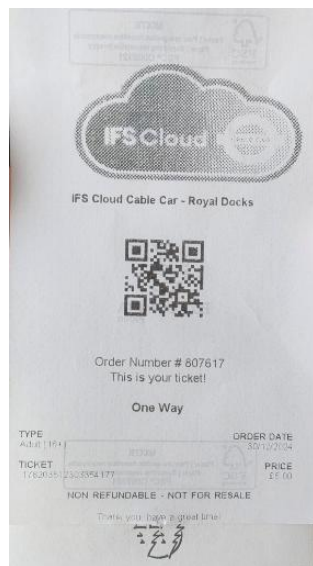
The next day, December 30th, 2024, I planned to ask people my questions. However, thinking about doing it and actually doing it are two different things, and I could not bring

myself to do it. Even though I interacted with different people, I did not dare ask them to answer my survey.

That day, I went to the O2 mall in Greenwich and took the cable car. It was a great day, and I had small interactions with people in different situations, such as in the cable car or in a restaurant. However, I was too shy to formally ask for my survey.

10. Activities and Daily Life Experiences

Despite this, I took the subway for the first time. I was initially scared because of my experience in Paris, but the subway in Woolwich was very clean, safe and pleasant. There were no bad smells or uncomfortable situations.

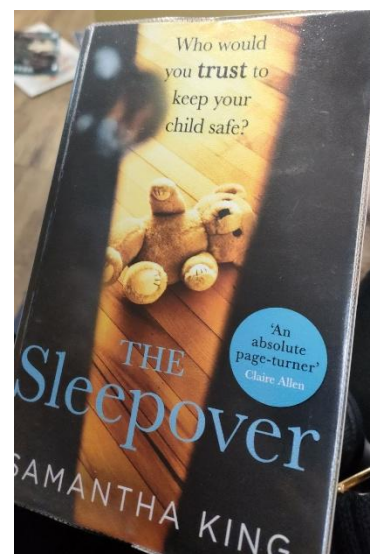


Regarding the cable car, I was excited because I thought the height would be very high, but in my opinion, it wasn't that impressive. However, it was still a great experience. I also had the opportunity to talk with people because I didn't know that I had to buy a ticket. I thought it worked like public transport, where you just tap your credit card, but it wasn't the case.

While waiting in the queue, I noticed a word I didn't know: "trespassing", which I understood as meaning that we are not allowed to enter.



The following day, December 31st, I decided to go to the library. I enjoy reading in English, and I needed some quiet time alone. I went to Bexley library and first started reading *Red Snow* by Will Dean, but I did not really like it. I then looked for another book and found *The Sleepover* by Samantha King, which I really enjoyed. I spent most of my day reading it and learned some new expressions such as “to cut someone off” and “make himself comfy.” It tells the story of a mother whose son, previously bullied, goes to a sleepover and suddenly disappears the next day. I stopped reading at chapter 6 because I had to leave. I tried to go back to the library on January 1st, but it was closed, unlike many places in France where shops and services remain open that day.



11. Progress in Communication

On January 1st, I started conducting my survey. My first attempt was unsuccessful, as the person I approached refused to answer. However, I continued and later met a perfume seller who agreed to participate. Although the exchange allowed me to practice speaking, the interaction became uncomfortable due to his personal questions. Despite this, it was a useful experience as it helped me overcome my hesitation and engage in conversation.



On January 2, 2025, I visited Tower Bridge. Although I was tired and did not actively try to start conversations, several people approached me. A British person identified me as French based on my accent, which led to a brief discussion about work and life in England. Later, I had another short interaction on the train, where I discussed food, politics and everyday topics with a passenger. He was really kind and we could discuss during all the journeys. These exchanges allowed me to practice my listening and speaking skills. I also noticed that the expression “take care” is commonly used in England, even with strangers.

I learned new vocabulary during the day, such as “pedestrian,” meaning a person walking in the street.

12. Final Days and Family Visit

On January 3, I planned to attend an event but faced transport issues due to a bus diversion, which forced me to walk and caused delays. Despite this, I was able to practice my listening skills by



following conversations on the bus, particularly with a strong British accent. I also noticed expressions such as “please mind your head.”

On January 4, my parents arrived. As they do not speak English, I acted as an interpreter in various situations, such as at the hotel and in restaurants. This pushed me to speak more and interact with others. I also had a conversation with a receptionist about languages, which highlighted the importance of speaking English internationally.

On January 5, we visited central London, including Big Ben. I discovered new expressions such as “mind the gap” in the underground. Throughout the day, I continued to communicate in English to help my parents, including asking for directions and speaking with staff. I also had a positive interaction with police officers who helped us find a parking solution. This experience reinforced my confidence in speaking, as I had to take the initiative in conversations.

13. Conclusion of the Language Stay

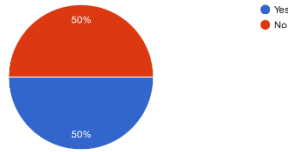
So, to conclude this first part of my language stay, it was a great experience to be in England. I am more used to the American accent than the British one, so this allowed me to improve my oral comprehension. Even when I was not speaking, I was constantly listening to people around me to practice.

Regarding the host family, the location was very convenient, as I was close to the centre of Bexleyheath, with many buses and a train station nearby. However, if I had to go back, I would not choose the same family. I expected to practice English with them and have daily interactions, but this was not the case. At the beginning, I felt quite isolated, as I could only stay in my room, which was not very large. Over time, I got used to it and accepted the situation. Nevertheless, the house was clean and very quiet, even too quiet for a family home.

As for London, even if it was not my first time there, I really enjoyed it. I particularly liked the architecture and spent hours walking through the streets, observing the buildings, which are both similar to and different from those in France. However, I had an unexpected surprise regarding transportation costs: although I initially thought that buses and the underground were cheap, I later realized that the payments were deducted from my account with a delay, and the total amount was quite high.

Finally, concerning my survey, I did not manage to ask many people, and some refused to answer. In the end, I only collected two responses:

1) Are you originally from England?
2 réponses



Kuala Lumpur

For my second part, with 15 days left, I decided to go far from what I am used to: a country where people speak English, probably because of its historical background: Malaysia. I arrived in Kuala Lumpur on the 8th, but I left home on the 7th. It was the longest journey I have ever made: 13 hours on a plane.

Before starting, I want to talk about jet lag. It is not a myth or something that only older people experience, as I used to think. I was sleeping twice a day, and the surprising part is that I was still tired. I could spend the whole day sleeping as if it were night.

However, I did not travel this far just to sleep.

Anyway, concerning the report of Malaysia, honestly, I think I have talk with so many people, more than when I was in London. I London I was in a family stay,

1. Arrival and First Impression

I stayed at the Santa Grand Signature Kuala Lumpur. When I arrived, I booked a taxi from the airport to the hotel, and I had my first and nice conversation. The driver explained things about his country and about life in general in Malaysia, because I was curious to know if the brake and the accelerator are reversed, since they drive on the left like in England. And the answer was yes: everything is the opposite. I did not know the word “brake”, so I tried to explain it to him, and he gave me the correct term.

After checking in, I went to rest because of the jet lag. Later in the evening, I went out and visited the Petronas Towers.



I explored the city, and because I really like Asian food, I was looking for 7-Eleven, a convenience store chain that is very common in Asian countries and that I

wanted to discover. I think I went to almost every 7-Eleven near my accommodation. I also discovered other similar stores such as “NICE to CU” and “FamilyMart”, which follow the same concept.



These convenience stores sell a wide variety of ready-to-eat food, both sweet and savoury. There are microwaves, hot water machines, and meals prepared on site such as tteokbokki, noodles, ramen, and many other dishes. They are open 24/7, which makes them very convenient. The concept is a mix between a supermarket and a small restaurant: you choose your food like in a shop, then you can eat it on site at the tables provided.

This experience also helped me practise English, since I am in a completely different country and culture, and I often need to ask for information. So I interact with a lot of people also because I am very exciting to be in an Asian country. I had many conversations with locals, which was very useful for my communication skills.

2. Language and Communication

Regarding English in Kuala Lumpur, many people speak English, especially among Indian and Chinese communities. However, accents can sometimes make understanding more difficult. The Indian accent, in particular, was sometimes challenging for me at first. For example, in my first 7-Eleven visit, I struggled to understand the staff, partly because of the accent and also because he was wearing a mask. Nevertheless, their level of English is generally good.

I planned to leave Kuala Lumpur to visit another place, but I did not have data anymore. I could not leave the city without internet access. I bought my SIM card at 7-Eleven with an employee who was quite difficult to understand. He also had difficulties understanding me when I asked about the data included in my plan. The only information I clearly understood was that I had “unlimited data”, which was confusing because it stopped after 1 GB of usage.

I then went to different 7-Eleven stores near my hotel, but they could not help me. At the third one, I was advised to return to the original store with my receipt so they could check the problem. So, I went back to the hotel and then returned to the 7-Eleven where I had bought the SIM card.

Fortunately, it was not the same employee as before. This time, the staff member spoke English very well. I explained my situation, and he clearly answered my questions, unlike the previous experience. The issue was that the SIM card required a PIN code to be activated through an app; otherwise, it would be blocked after 1 GB of data. He helped

me complete the process and we checked everything together. The assistance was very helpful and professional.

3. Daily Life and Interactions

After that, I visited several buildings around the Petronas Twin Towers, because my father was interested in investing in an apartment there. I visited different buildings, checked all the information and for some, booked another appointment, and in some of them, I also had conversations about where I was from and where the people were from.

The situation did not improve at the hotel, because I had to constantly deal with small issues: when the staff cleaned my room, they sometimes forgot things like towels, toilet paper, or even the TV remote control stopped working. So, I ended up interacting with them every day.

The morning before leaving, my father asked me to check if it was possible to book a taxi from the hotel to the airport. I also asked about how to go to Putrajaya, outside Kuala Lumpur. At first, the receptionist didn't really know, but then he explained and gave me a map with annotations.

I really liked this stay because I was practicing English at every moment, from breakfast to the evening when I came back to the hotel. There were many British, American, and Australian guests in the hotel, so even in the elevator, I often had small conversations about different topics, like clothing or daily life.

The day after, when I wanted to go near the Petronas Twin Towers again, the street was blocked by police. I asked what was happening, but the first officer only told me that I could not enter and should come back another day. He didn't answer my question, so I insisted a bit.

Then I noticed another officer, and I decided to ask him instead. This time, he explained that the Prime Minister was coming, which is why the area was closed.

I waited for about 30 minutes, but he still hadn't arrived, so I left. I think that if I knew more about Malaysian politics, like I do for England or the USA, I would have stayed. But at that time, I didn't even know his political party or much about him. I only knew that he was the Prime Minister.

So, I decided to do my own research later.

The good point is when I arrived, I could notice that I was making mistakes when I was speaking because I had lost the habit. But now, little by little, I am making fewer mistakes when I talk. However, the first day was completely crazy: each time I was thinking that what I was saying did not make any sense, but the sentence was already out of my mouth.

4. Scam Experience

I was approached by scammers who thought I was Malaysian. I was fully on my guard, but at the same time I was not focused enough on the man who was trying to confuse me. He kept changing his story: first he said he was from Dubai, then from Morocco, then that he had lived one year in Dubai, then that he had been in Malaysia for a month, but finally that he had just arrived and had been living in Morocco. It was completely incoherent.

At the same time, I was more focused on another man who was getting closer and closer to me. Suddenly, a woman, who was clearly with them, came out of nowhere. The man who was trying to confuse me asked me to show him euros, then Moroccan money, then Algerian money. But I am not from Morocco, and I only had Malaysian currency and euros. Of course, I did not show him anything. Then he showed me a wad of 100-dollar bills, probably to impress me or make me feel comfortable, but it did not work at all.

The situation became very strange. The more I stepped back, the more they moved closer. At some point, I felt overwhelmed, so I just turned around and left without saying a word or waiting for them to finish. I felt really uncomfortable, and I could not understand anything they were saying, especially since they kept changing their stories. The woman came very close to me, and the two men were also getting closer and closer. So, I just left immediately.

They were not from Malaysia, and not even from an Asian country. One of the men had a very long nail on his little finger, which I had heard can be a custom among some communities, but I am not completely sure.

5. Cultural Discoveries and Conversations

After that, I met a kind woman that I had already seen three days before. She had been very nice to me the first time. We had only had a short discussion about where I am from, and since she is a volunteer in that place, she is used to meeting many foreigners. Just like the first time, she came to me and recognized me immediately. She even remembered where I am from, which really touched me.

This time, we had a much longer discussion. The first time, she was the one asking questions, but this time I was the one asking. I had heard many times that Malaysia is a Muslim country, but when I arrived in Kuala Lumpur, I saw many Chinese and Indian people and almost any Malaysian people. I have nothing against that, but I was surprised. She explained to me that it is because Kuala Lumpur is a relatively new city, largely developed by Chinese and Indian communities. That is why the architecture is different and similar to China and why these communities are very present there.

She also explained the history of the country, including British colonization and the political system. There is not only one king: each state has its own ruler, who can be a king, a sultan, or a governor. I realized afterwards that I forgot to ask why some states have

a king while others have a sultan or a governor. However, she did explain to me the difference between a governor and a king.

We also talked about my country of origin. She mentioned that people from my country have distinct facial features compared to others, so it was my turn to explain the history of my country. It was a very interesting discussion, and I really enjoyed it.

Finally, she recommended some places to visit, such as Malacca, which is known for its historical port. However, I am not sure if I will be able to go there, as it is quite far and I do not know if it is possible to go and come back in the same day.

On my first day, when I met her, I had taken a taxi, and I asked the driver about every interesting building we passed. That is how he showed me the Prime Minister's offices.



Then, **pink mosque:**



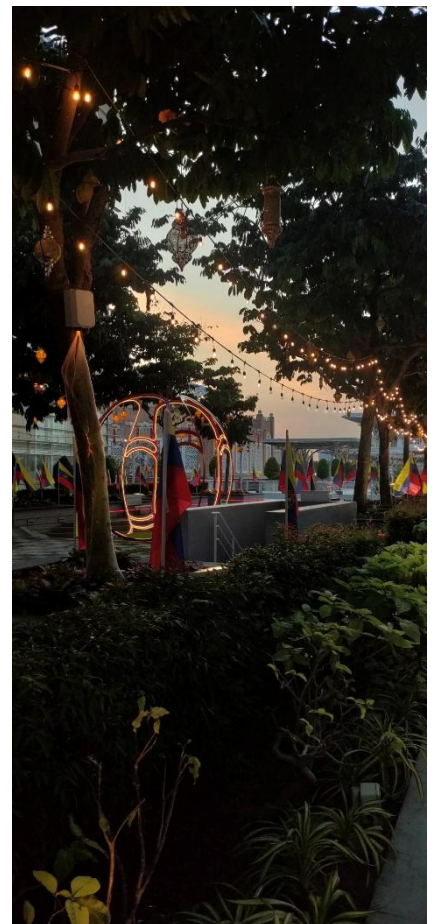
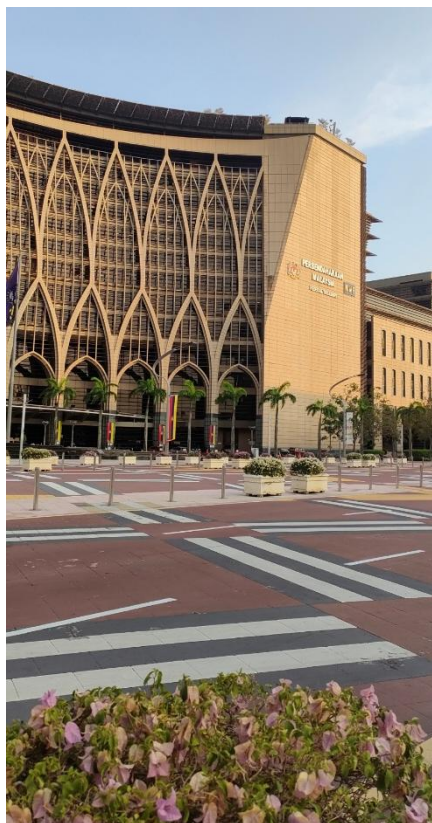
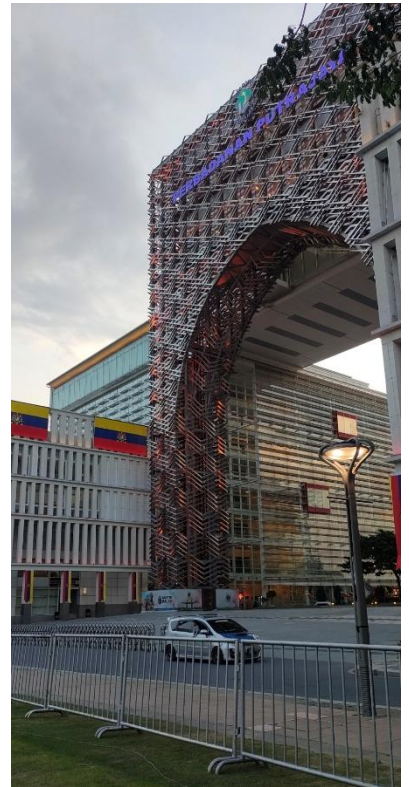
The courthouse:



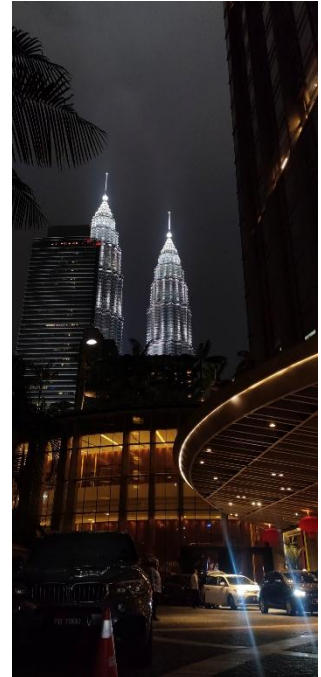
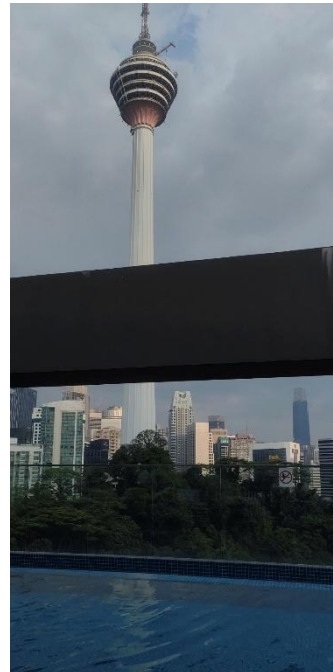
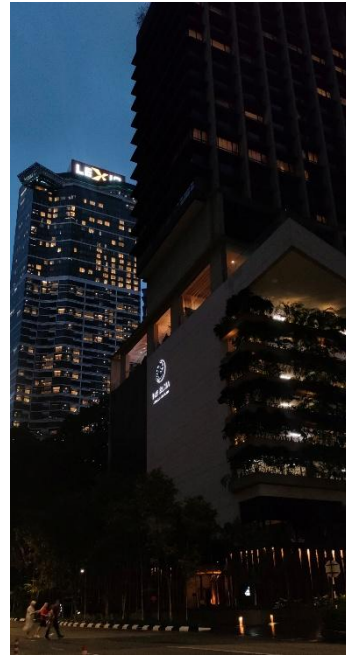
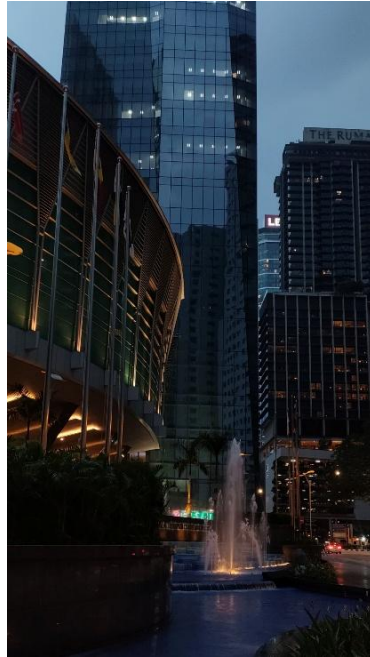
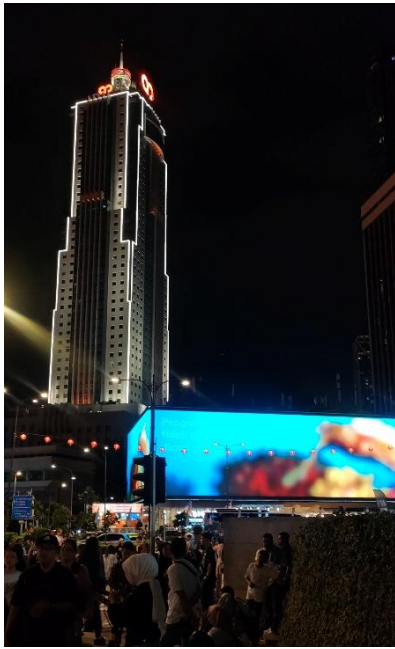
I did wish I could visit the courthouse.

This place was incredible. It was a new place, I guess, and the building was impressing from what I could see in Kuala Lumpur centre.

This place was called: **Putrajaya**



As you will be able to see in a second, it's totally different from Kuala Lumpur centre:



The city centre really looks like a Chinese city. I couldn't take pictures of every building, but when I came back to Kuala Lumpur in the evening, I could clearly see it from the taxi. According to the woman I met, Malaysians owe much of this city to the Chinese and Indian workers who came to build it, which is why these communities are still very present today.

6. Food Discovery and New Vocabulary

The food here is also totally different, and I could clearly see the difference. I was able to



learn new vocabulary about food, especially different ways to cook eggs: *half-boiled eggs*, *scrambled eggs*, *over-easy*, *omelette*, and *sunny-side up*, thanks to an egg stand.

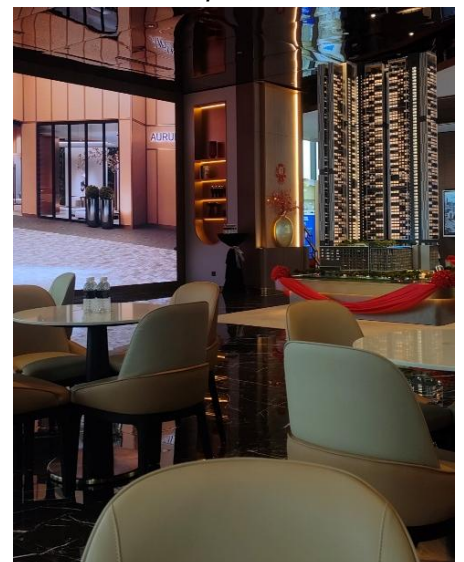
So the next day, I kept ordering eggs in all these different ways, even when I did not particularly want eggs.

7. Real Estate Mission and Language Challenges

As I mentioned, my father sent me on a mission: to find a place where he could invest. Since Kuala Lumpur is a new and very large city, it was quite easy to find projects. I visited many sales offices, or rather *marketing suites*, because the projects were for buildings that had not yet been built.

The first time I went, I realized that I did not have enough vocabulary related to real estate. I did not know how to say *showroom*, *surface*, *loan*, *agreement*, *developer*, *service charges*, and many other terms that I cannot remember now.

When I found a good project in a good location, everything seemed perfect, so I told them I was interested. I think that was a mistake, because even one week after returning to France and restarting university, I was still receiving messages asking if I was still interested, even if before leaving I told them that I was not going to continue for different reason. My father has high expectations quality and perfect finish is super important for him.



8. Meetings, Negotiations, and Intensive Practice

Before leaving Kuala Lumpur, I had several appointments with them, almost every day. It started when I met them in a mall, just after escaping another scam attempt similar to the previous one, where people try to make you show money.



After that, I met two men who explained the project to me, and since I showed interest, we scheduled another meeting for the next day. During that meeting, I called my father and acted as a translator, since he does not speak English. It was difficult at the beginning, but I managed. I had no choice but to learn the vocabulary on the spot.

The following day, we arranged a meeting with a bank. Again, I had to learn new vocabulary. After that, my father asked me to visit other banks to verify the information and compare offers.

9. Banks and a Surprising Discovery About Taxes

I visited several banks. At RHB Bank, I asked about taxes for foreigners. They confirmed what I had been told: many foreigners do not pay these taxes, and the government does not always enforce them. I was honestly speechless.

I then visited Affin Bank, but communication was more difficult, and I could not get all the answers I needed.

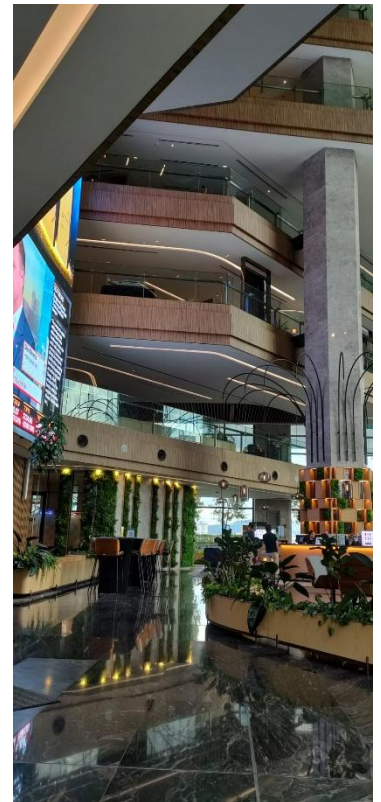
Finally, I went to HSBC. I was lucky because I arrived just before closing time. The security guard called a staff member so I could still ask my questions. The employees were extremely kind, took their time, and answered everything.

This situation really surprised me, because in France, it would be very unlikely to receive help after closing time. In Malaysia, people were calm, respectful, and patient.

10. Cultural Observations and Daily Interactions

I noticed that people in Malaysia are generally calmer and more approachable. Everywhere I went (7-Eleven, banks, hotel, markets, restaurants, people in the street) asked me where I was from and tried to start conversations.

This allowed me to learn a lot about the country's history and culture through daily interactions.





11. Museum Visit and Cultural Learning

I also had the opportunity to visit a museum in Kuala Lumpur. Unlike London, where museums were expensive for my budget, this one was accessible.

It was very interesting to learn about the history of the country, the different sultans, traditional clothing, and how Malaysia developed its international relations. I enjoy this type of museum because it helps to understand the past of a country.

I also tried to visit the National Museum, but it was closed, and I did not have time to go back.



12. Final Reflection on the Experience

To conclude this trip, I had the opportunity to travel to both London and Kuala Lumpur for this language stay. The stay in London was good, but not as dynamic as the one in Malaysia.

In Malaysia, I spoke much more, learned more, and had more interactions, both with people outside and in the hotel. I spent my days talking and discovering new things. Even in taxis, I had conversations about the country.

This experience was very useful, especially because when I returned, I had an oral exam where I had to simulate a conversation in a travel agency. Since I had spent around 15 days asking questions and speaking with people, I did not need to prepare a text. I simply did what I had been doing during my entire stay.

Reservation:

Confirmation de la réservation

Merci Rofrane pour votre réservation sur Homestay.com !

Votre réservation est confirmée pour votre séjour chez Shamina in Bexleyheath. La confirmation d'une réservation implique que vous connaissez et acceptez de respecter le règlement intérieur de l'hôte ainsi que ses propres politiques d'annulation telles qu'affichées sur son profil. Veuillez vérifier votre réservation ci-dessous.

Nous vous recommandons de prendre contact avec Shamina avant son arrivée.

Nous vous souhaitons un bon séjour !

L'équipe de Homestay

N° de référence : HS16J0LJ4

Arrivée	Départ	Invités	Chambres	Nuits
20 décembre 2024	5 janvier 2025	1	1	16

Informations sur le paiement

Prix du séjour	£480,00 GBP (€550.35 EUR)
Frais de Réservation	£72,00 GBP (€82.55 EUR)
Total	£552,00 GBP (€632.91 EUR)
Mode de paiement	Visa
Payé	£192,00 GBP (€220.14 EUR)
Due à l'hôte	£360,00 GBP (€412.76 EUR)



Il est temps de prendre le
large,
bon voyage!
Nous vous souhaitons une
excellente traversée.

Numéro de référence DFDS Seaways:
20936616

Numéro de référence Direct Ferries:
DFP179713000

Traversée Aller

Départ

Calais

ven. 20 décembre
08:25



Durée

Arrivée

Douvres

ven. 20 décembre
08:55

Vous naviguez avec

DFDS Seaways



Enregistrement au plus tard **60 minutes avant le
départ.**

Comment nous contacter



L'heure de votre traversée
approche, voici donc quelques
informations utiles pour
faciliter votre voyage

Numéro de référence DFDS Seaways:
24392474

Numéro de référence Direct Ferries:
DFP179708695

Traversée Retour

Départ

Douvres

dim. 5 janvier 19:40



Durée

Arrivée

Calais

dim. 5 janvier 22:10

Vous naviguez avec

DFDS Seaways



Enregistrement au plus tard **60 minutes avant le
départ.**

VENDREDI 7 FÉVRIER

Aller ➔

⌚ 17h 30m

07:50

Brussels (Belgium)
BRU · Aéroport
Brussels National

Turkish Airlines · TK 1942

N° de référence de la compagnie aérienne
ST8J6N

⌚ 3H 30M

📦 ÉCONOMIQUE

13:20

Istanbul (Turkey)
IST · Aéroport Istanbul Airport

Correspondance : Changement d'avion

⌚

Durée de l'escale : 4 heures 00 min.
Veuillez consulter l'heure d'embarquement et la porte auprès de la compagnie aérienne.

17:20

Istanbul (Turkey)
IST · Aéroport
Istanbul Airport

Turkish Airlines · TK 62

N° de référence de la compagnie aérienne
ST8J6N

⌚ 10H

📦 ÉCONOMIQUE

🌅

SAMEDI 8 FÉVRIER

08:20

Kuala Lumpur (Malaysia)
KUL · Aéroport Kuala Lumpur INTL

SAMEDI 22 FÉVRIER

Retour ➔

⌚ 19h

10:00

Kuala Lumpur (Malaysia)
KUL · Aéroport Kuala Lumpur INTL

Turkish Airlines · TK 63

N° de référence de la compagnie aérienne
ST8J6N

⌚ 11H 30M

📦 ÉCONOMIQUE

16:30

Istanbul (Turkey)
IST · Aéroport Istanbul Airport

Correspondance : Changement d'avion

⌚

Durée de l'escale : 3 heures 55 min.
Veuillez consulter l'heure d'embarquement et la porte auprès de la compagnie aérienne.

20:25

Istanbul (Turkey)
IST · Aéroport
Istanbul Airport

Turkish Airlines · TK 1941

N° de référence de la compagnie aérienne
ST8J6N

⌚ 3H 35M

📦 ÉCONOMIQUE

22:00

Brussels (Belgium)
BRU · Aéroport Brussels National



Address:
Agoda Company Pte, Ltd.
36 Robinson Road
City House #20-01
Singapore 068877

N° de réservation 483250779
Date de paiement November 9, 2024

Reçu

Nom et adresse du client	
Nom	Rofrane BOUAKSA
Courrier électronique	r.bouaksa17@gmail.com

Description		Montant
Nom de l'hôtel	Santa Grand Signature Kuala Lumpur	
Période	February 8, 2025 - February 22, 2025 (14 nuit(s))	
Type de chambre	Bong Soo Superior Twin	
Nb de chambres	1	
Nb de lits suppl.	0	
Montant total des chambres		USD 709.00
Montant total des lits suppl.		USD 0.00
MONTANT TOTAL		USD 709.00
Prix total		EUR 662,54 (USD 709.00)

Ce reçu a été généré automatiquement par notre système.

